YOUR LEARNING LIBRARY

Your UPSC learning programme

Public study guide. Track your own answers, progress and next steps privately in the study dashboard. Download this plan as a PDF.

You do not need to call yourself intelligent before you begin. You need a manageable task, an explanation you can understand, and repeated practice. School marks do not establish your intelligence or decide your future result. We will measure what you can explain and solve, then choose the next step.

Starting routine: 4 hours a day, simple English with short Hindi explanations, six study days and one light/rest day. Adjust the workload to your actual commitments. This programme supports beginners, including learners pursuing a recognised degree and optionally preparing for one Class 12-level recruitment examination. Degree status, qualification, exam language, eligibility and attempt year must be established for each learner; they are not assumed by this public guide.

Start here today

1. Try the 20-minute starting check. It identifies topics to teach; it is not an IQ test.
2. Read Lesson 1: rules, government and the Constitution.
3. Close the lesson and answer its three questions in your own words. Send the answers to your mentor or record them for later feedback. A one-sentence answer is enough to start.
4. Log what you actually did, the answers you gave, and the next task. Leave anything unfinished marked **not attempted**.

The starting routine allows 4 hours a day, but today does not need to be a four-hour test of willpower. Begin with the check and Lesson 1; ramp toward the full routine over the next one to two weeks. A 25–35 minute beginning is useful. Do not catch up by doubling tomorrow's workload.

What we are preparing for

Use the official exam guide for the examination overview, source links and the status of official verification. The guide labels what has and has not been verified; do not treat an unverified age/date/proof deadline as current. Check the notification for your intended attempt when it is available; a coaching calendar or an old notification is not a substitute. Class 12 alone is not the usual CSE degree qualification: a recognised bachelor's degree/equivalent under the applicable rules is a key prerequisite. **Being in the second year of a bachelor's degree is not a blanket qualification to sit CSE.** Limited final-year/result-awaited provisions may apply under the official rules; they must not be assumed to cover a second-year student. Exact eligibility, proof deadlines and any conditional route require that attempt's official notification. We will not set an attempt year merely by adding three years to today.

The programme includes:

- **Prelims:** General Studies and CSAT. CSAT needs practice from the first week, including comprehension, arithmetic and reasoning. A qualifying paper can still prevent progression.

- **Mains:** Essay; GS I (history, culture, geography and society); GS II (Constitution, polity, governance, social justice and international relations); GS III (economy, agriculture, science and technology, environment, security and disaster management); GS IV (ethics, integrity and aptitude); and both papers of one optional subject.
- **Qualifying language papers:** check the applicable English/Indian-language requirements and exemptions against the official notice. Do a reading/writing baseline after the intended exam-writing language and applicable requirements are known. Do not silently omit these papers.
- **Personality test:** develop clear thinking, honest answers and awareness of your background throughout. Interview-specific practice belongs later, after the relevant stage and with the applicable official requirements.

PYQ means *previous-year question*. It shows the kind of understanding UPSC has asked for. First read a question to see its demand, then learn the concept, and finally try answering without notes. PYQs are evidence about past questions, not a list of guaranteed future topics.

How each teaching session works

The mentor should teach **one small concept at a time**:

1. Explain it using ordinary life and define unfamiliar words.
2. State where the everyday analogy stops working.
3. Show one worked example.
4. Ask you to explain it back, without copying.
5. Give one short application question and provide specific feedback.
6. Record your answer, misunderstanding, correction and next review date.

Use a Hindi phrase if it helps comprehension, then connect it to the formal exam term. Example: *Sarkar chalane ke buniyadi niyam* → the basic rules and institutions for governing. We will gradually practise the language in which you intend to write the examination.

Reading a page is **exposure**, not proof of mastery. Correct answers after seeing the solution are **assisted**. Label an answer **independent** only when attempted without help. Confidence and correctness are recorded separately.

Daily schedules

Use the **4-hour column as your eventual baseline**, with the 2-hour column as a ramp-up or busy-day fallback. More hours help only when attention, sleep and review remain workable. The time blocks below include breaks and a short log. Until your college/work timetable is known, treat the four hours as the available independent-study budget; do not silently stack four UPSC hours on top of a demanding degree schedule.

Activity	2 hours	4 hours	6 hours
Recall/review from memory	10 min	20 min	30 min

Activity	2 hours	4 hours	6 hours
Main GS concept and reading	40 min	70 min	90 min
CSAT practice	20 min	30 min	40 min
One current-affairs issue	15 min	25 min	30 min
Degree planning/coursework, or extra foundation reading when appropriate	—	35 min	70 min
Output: MCQs, short writing, essay/language practice	20 min	15 min	30 min
Job-exam target selection/specific practice; typing only if relevant	—	20 min	30 min
Breaks	10 min	20 min	30 min
Update the learning record	5 min	5 min	10 min
Total	**120 min**	**240 min**	**360 min**

If you need a degree, use the degree block first for checking admissions and programmes, then for coursework after enrolment; otherwise use it for your current study priorities. Thirty-five minutes will not necessarily cover college demands: near assignments or degree exams, replace additional GS/current-affairs blocks with coursework and keep a small recall/CSAT habit. Formal classes, travel, paid work and sleep must also fit. Job-exam preparation shares this four-hour budget: the CSAT/reading blocks provide transferable skills, and the 20-minute job block covers a verified target's specific needs. They are not four UPSC hours plus an extra job-exam course. At 2 hours, protect essential coursework, reading and basic numeracy; reduce new UPSC material. Optional-subject study comes later and replaces existing blocks rather than adding hidden hours. This is a study budget, not a promise that a specific attempt is achievable in those hours.

On the light/rest day, do at most 15–20 minutes of due recall and planning. Take full rest when needed. If the review queue grows beyond 20 minutes daily, reduce new material before adding time. Keep one buffer session each week after the first month for unfinished work.

Degree pathway: a practical project if you need a degree

If you already hold an eligible degree, check your qualification against the relevant notice and adapt these blocks to your present commitments. If you have not enrolled, use the steps below.

A recognised bachelor's degree can provide the educational qualification and a useful career foundation. **BA is not compulsory for UPSC.** Choose a subject and route you can complete, afford and use beyond one examination. A “UPSC-friendly” label should not outweigh your interests, employment options or ability to finish.

If choosing a degree, create a small comparison of two or three genuine programmes:

1. Note the awarding university, exact degree title, subject, duration, study mode, entry requirements, total fees, examination arrangements and admission window. Verify the details through the institution's official admissions office/site.
2. For regular study, verify the awarding institution's recognition and the college's affiliation where applicable. For distance/online study, check **the exact institution, programme, mode and relevant admission session** through the applicable UGC/DEB recognition or entitlement records; a familiar

university name alone is insufficient. Check any programme-specific professional-regulator requirement too.

3. Compare attendance/contact classes, internet needs, travel, practical work and examination centres against your real routine. A recognised distance/online route can be a possibility when suitable; recognition must be checked before payment.
4. Prefer official application/payment channels. Reject promises of an “instant”, backdated or guaranteed degree. Keep receipts and official admission confirmation.
5. Enrol only after these checks and record the confirmation date. A learner who has not received admission confirmation should keep the status **not enrolled**. Do not write a graduation year based on an unverified course length or assume a first eligible UPSC attempt.

The mentor can help compare publicly available programme information. You do not need to put identity-document numbers, marksheet images or payment credentials in this portable learning kit.

An optional parallel route toward a Class 12-level government job

Use this track only if it matches your employment goals; otherwise put the time into the degree, core skills or GS. First select **one** target after checking its current official notice. Possible categories to investigate include SSC CHSL and RRB NTPC undergraduate posts; these are examples, not a statement that an application is currently open or that every post is suitable for you. Qualification details, age cutoffs, subject requirements, post-specific conditions, skill tests and dates vary. UPSC, SSC and railway examinations are different exams with different demands.

1. Compare two current or most recent official notices: educational qualification, age on the stated cutoff date, applicable category conditions, stages, syllabus, examination language and typing/skill requirements. Record which notice year was actually checked. Recheck a new notice when it appears.
2. Pick one manageable target. Use basic arithmetic, reasoning and English/comprehension as shared foundations, but do not assume CSAT practice alone covers the target syllabus.
3. Use the daily 20-minute job block for target-specific questions or, **if required**, accurate typing practice. In the first week, use it to understand the target and attempt a small baseline. Speed practice follows accuracy.
4. Once a genuine exam date is known, rotate additional GS blocks toward that exam for a defined period. Keep degree deadlines protected and a small UPSC reading/review habit. Resume the broader plan afterward.
5. Build employability alongside exams: clear writing, basic computer use and degree-related skills. Keep these useful even if an examination result is disappointing.

Until a target is verified and selected, log **job target: undecided**. Do not pay for an application, course or “guaranteed government job” based only on an unofficial advertisement.

A multi-year route, with useful milestones

For a learner who still needs a degree, the path begins with the degree route and stronger learning foundations. Learners who already hold the required qualification can adapt the phases to their own calendar. It is not a demand to repeat the UPSC syllabus continuously for several years. The degree's actual length and your eligibility determine the calendar.

Stage	Main objective	Evidence at the checkpoint
Next 2–4 weeks	Compare recognised degree options and one Class 12-level job target, establish a study routine and begin the first lessons	Official programme/notice checks logged; actual enrolment status clear; starting answers recorded
First 8–12 weeks	Gentle foundations in reading, arithmetic, civics, maps, timelines and basic economy; build confidence through understandable practice	Can explain sampled concepts and solve basic questions with fewer hints; adjust from the four-week review
First degree semester/year	Complete coursework well; build English/Hindi reading, numeracy, writing and a broad social-science foundation; prepare for the selected job exam	Degree assignments/exams on track; job-specific practice reviewed; a small library of useful notes and monthly progress reviews
Middle degree semesters/years, if applicable	Deepen core GS steadily; explore an optional after foundations; write short answers and practise CSAT regularly	Topic coverage mapped to syllabus; improving delayed recall and mixed-question performance; optional choice based on samples
Approximately the final 12–18 months before a plausible eligible attempt, adjusted to evidence	Shift to a focused exam programme: complete/revise GS and both optional papers, use official PYQs, build timed papers and applicable language practice	Degree and eligibility dates verified; syllabus gaps explicit; repeated timed evidence informs readiness
Final-year/graduation transition	Confirm the exact attempt-year education/age/attempt/nationality provisions, final-year conditions if relevant and document deadlines	Official notification checked; required proof actually available or a clearly applicable permitted route confirmed

The 12–18 month window is a planning range, not a recommended fixed attempt date or a promise of readiness. If foundations, degree demands or practice results require more time, change the plan. Keep developing degree-related skills and employment options alongside preparation.

First four weeks

These are a foundation sample, not the full UPSC syllabus. Use each **main task** in the main-concept block: up to 70 minutes at the 4-hour routine, including reading and a worked example; 40 minutes on a shorter day. Use the CSAT and output blocks as described below. Use the degree/foundation block for the programme checklist or extra basic reading, and the job block for choosing/checking one target and its specific requirements. Do not spend the whole first month building notes or watching long playlists.

Week 1: learn how to learn, then understand public rules

Day	Main task	CSAT / basic skill	What to produce
1	Starting check and Lesson 1; split across two sessions if needed	The check supplies today's arithmetic/comprehension baseline	Attempt the three Lesson 1 questions; record answers, not only a score
2	Recall Lesson 1; learn democracy and representation through a class-representative example	Place value, the four operations; try five small sums and explain one method	Explain why voting alone does not describe every feature of democracy in 3–4 sentences
3	Learn legislature, executive and judiciary; compare their roles	Fractions as parts of a whole; five simple problems	Match six examples to the relevant institution and explain one choice
4	Recall Lesson 1; learn rights, responsibilities and limits on public power	Fractions, decimals and percentages as different forms of the same amount	Describe one right and one public duty without treating them as interchangeable
5	Learn Union, state and local levels using a water-supply example; identify that real responsibilities may overlap	Read a 150–200 word passage; answer main-idea and evidence questions	Draw a three-level diagram and list one verified function at each level
6	Consolidate Days 1–5; read two official polity PYQs with mentor help	Three easy percentage problems and two reasoning questions	Attempt five mixed recall questions and one 60–80 word explanation
7	Light day or rest; review the actual log and plan next week	No new topic	Record what was difficult, what helped and which reviews are due

Day 1 time override (up to 2 hours): 10 min orientation, 20 min starting check, 30 min Lesson 1, 20 min exercises, 15 min inspect the official syllabus/PYQ source with help, 10 min breaks, 15 min record and organise. Stop sooner if fatigued; unfinished work carries forward visibly.

For the current-affairs block this week, pick **one** explainable public issue on each study day. Identify the institution involved, define one new term and write one question. The mentor must distinguish verified facts from opinion and date time-sensitive facts. No need to memorise every headline.

Week 2: geography and maps

Day	Main task	CSAT / output focus
8	Due recall of Lesson 1; read a map legend, directions, scale and coordinates	Five direction/scale exercises; draw India from reference without aiming for artistic accuracy
9	Understand landforms: mountains, plains and plateaus	Ratios with everyday quantities; label three landform examples from a reliable atlas
10	Trace the water cycle and a river from source to mouth	Percentages continued; explain why upstream activity can affect downstream people
11	Distinguish weather from climate; introduce seasons and the monsoon at a basic level	One comprehension passage; explain the distinction in four sentences
12	Connect soils, water and crops without memorising long lists	Five basic arithmetic questions; build a crop–condition table with three examples

Day	Main task	CSAT / output focus
13	Review maps and the week's concepts; inspect two official geography PYQs	Five mixed questions plus one 80-word explanation; record errors by cause
14	Light recall/rest; review progress on the degree comparison	Record unresolved recognition/admission questions; no compulsory new work

Week 3: history and society

Day	Main task	CSAT / output focus
15	Learn timeline, century, cause and consequence; build a six-event timeline from a school chapter	Reading a small table; answer using evidence rather than guesses
16	Learn what colonial rule means and one economic effect in India	Ratios/percentages mixed; write cause → mechanism → effect
17	Learn the broad purpose of the freedom movement and compare two methods of protest	One comprehension passage; explain a similarity and a difference
18	Connect the freedom struggle to constitution-making without assuming an automatic/instant transition	Simple averages; write a 100-word connected explanation with help
19	Explore diversity, inequality and social change using a respectful everyday example	Five basic data questions; separate a fact, an interpretation and a stereotype
20	Review the timeline; inspect one history and one society PYQ	Ten mixed recall/MCQ items; analyse every error, including lucky guesses
21	Light recall/rest; schedule the Lesson 1 Day-21 review for Day 22 if learned on Day 1	Record the week and next priorities

Week 4: economy, environment and a first checkpoint

Day	Main task	CSAT / output focus
22	Due Lesson 1 recall; distinguish income, spending, saving, government revenue and public expenditure	Household arithmetic example; explain why a government budget is not exactly a household budget
23	Understand prices and inflation using a small basket of goods	Percentage change; distinguish higher prices from a faster rate of price increase
24	Learn production, work and public services; distinguish an indicator from a person's welfare	Read a chart; explain one limitation of judging progress with one number
25	Learn ecosystem, food chain and biodiversity using a local setting	One comprehension passage; explain what may change if one species declines
26	Connect one environmental issue to policy; discuss a simple ethics dilemma	Compare two choices, people affected, relevant values and a reasoned action
27	Four-week checkpoint: 15 mixed GS questions, a short CSAT set and one 100-word explanation	Attempt first, then analyse; sample one official CSAT passage and one official numeracy question without a speed target

Day	Main task	CSAT / output focus
28	Rest and plan adjustment	Review evidence, degree-pathway status and hours actually available; set the next four-week plan

In each week, one output block can be used for a short English/Indian-language passage and summary once the relevant paper requirements and chosen languages are confirmed. This establishes a language baseline without adding another daily task.

The programme after the first month

Progress by evidence, not merely by crossing dates off a calendar. These learning phases sit inside the multi-year degree pathway above. Revise their duration after each four-week checkpoint; they are not all due this year. After Week 4, use Weeks 5–12 to strengthen the weakest foundations and broaden school-level understanding rather than racing to advanced coaching material.

Phase	Work	Gate before increasing difficulty
1. Foundation (starts with Weeks 1–4)	Reading comprehension, arithmetic, basic maps, government, historical timelines, economy vocabulary and learning routine	Explain several sampled concepts without notes; solve basic arithmetic with a stated method; sustain a realistic weekly routine. Re-teach weak domains rather than restarting everything
2. Cover the core syllabus	Polity, modern history, geography, economy, environment, science basics and society; add culture, world history, post-independence history, governance, social justice and international relations	Every syllabus heading has a first-pass source, a short note or concept map, and a relevant question attempted. A first pass still needs revision
3. Integrate Prelims and Mains	Topic-linked PYQs, elimination/reasoning practice, current issues connected to static concepts; agriculture, security, disaster management and technology; regular GS writing, essay, ethics and optional study	Error rate improves across mixed sets and delayed recall; short answers address the command word, supply relevant evidence and stay within a limit
4. Exam-stage preparation	Use the verified exam calendar to balance Prelims, CSAT, optional and Mains readiness; introduce timed sectional and then full papers	Repeated realistic timed evidence, including CSAT, informs readiness; one good mock or a coaching rank does not establish readiness
5. Mains-focused preparation	After Prelims, shift immediately to GS I–IV, essay, both optional papers and applicable language papers while awaiting results	Complete papers within time with legible, relevant answers; feedback addresses substance, structure and omissions
6. Interview preparation when relevant	Background/application details, home region, public issues, ethical judgment and clear conversation; practise saying “I don't know” honestly	Give balanced, specific, truthful answers and handle follow-up questions without memorised speeches

At the Phase 2 checkpoint, explicitly inspect every Mains syllabus heading. Subjects easily missed in a Prelims-heavy plan—world history, post-independence India, society, governance, international relations, security, disaster management, ethics and essay—must have scheduled work.

CSAT from the beginning

- Start with comprehension and numeracy diagnostics; teach the missing prerequisite, such as fractions, before shortcuts.
- Rotate comprehension, arithmetic (percentages, ratios, averages and later time/work/speed), reasoning and data interpretation.
- Start untimed. Add short timed sets only after the method is understood, then practise official full papers in exam conditions.
- Record wrong answers, slow answers and guesses separately. Review whether the issue was knowledge, comprehension, calculation or time.
- Work toward a reliable margin above the official qualifying requirement, using several recent official papers or equivalent practice. The margin is a planning safeguard, not a prediction.

Mains, essay and ethics

- Begin with a correct 3–4 sentence explanation. Move to 80–100 words, then official question formats and time limits as ability develops.
- Parse the command word: **describe** what it is; **explain** how/why; **analyse** how the parts and causes relate; **evaluate** weigh strengths and limits before reaching a judgment. Real questions may combine these.
- From Week 3, write two short answers a week inside the output block. After foundations, build toward regular GS answers with feedback and occasional timed sections.
- From Week 4, discuss one ethics case a week: facts, stakeholders, values, options, consequences and justified action. Later add ethics theory, attitude, integrity, public-service values, emotional intelligence, thinkers and probity as listed in the syllabus.
- Start essays with a thesis and outline once every two weeks. Progress to full essays and a timed paper after you can sustain a clear argument. Use examples you can explain and verify; do not invent quotations or statistics.

Choosing and preparing an optional

After the first 8–12 weeks, or later when foundations and college study are stable, shortlist two or three subjects from the official list. Read their actual syllabi and recent question papers, try an introductory lesson in each and write a short answer. Compare interest, comprehension, reliable resource access, language support and willingness to study the entire subject. Graduation background and GS overlap may help but do not determine the choice. Claims about a permanently “highest-scoring” optional are not a sound basis.

Choose provisionally after these samples, then schedule **both papers** explicitly. Reconsider only with evidence of a substantial mismatch; repeated switching loses study time. At any daily budget, optional work must fit alongside the degree by rotating other blocks; it may extend the preparation horizon. There is no need to force a choice this month, but avoid leaving optional study until after the Prelims of the intended attempt.

Sources: a small, staged library

1. **Always:** the official syllabus, current applicable notice and official previous papers, linked in the exam guide.
2. **First month:** relevant free NCERT school-textbook chapters on government, geography, history and basic economics, plus a reliable map/atlas. Pick chapters to answer today's question; do not buy or read every textbook immediately. Textbook names and editions change, so verify the actual chapter contents.
3. **After the first checkpoint:** choose one main reference per subject only when school-level explanations are insufficient. Finish and revise it before adding another book or lecture series for the same topic. The mentor should propose the specific edition/chapter at that stage and explain the need.
4. **Current affairs:** one credible newspaper or a manageable summary source, with official documents for important claims. Keep one issue note: what happened, why it matters, syllabus link, two viewpoints/constraints and source/date. Avoid collecting multiple daily compilations.
5. **Optional:** choose its sources only after comparing the syllabus and sample lessons.

Do not start with paid coaching, a large shopping list or hours of motivational videos. If a resource is inaccessible, the mentor can teach the concept directly and identify a lawful accessible alternative.

Review and correction rules

For a new concept, propose retrieval checks **1, 3, 7 and 21 days after the actual learning attempt**, not after the day this kit was generated. For Lesson 1 learned on study Day 1, that usually means Days 2, 4, 8 and 22. These are adjustable starting intervals, not a scientifically exact schedule for every learner.

- Recall correctly **and explain/apply**: keep the next interval or extend modestly.
- Partly correct, guessed or needed hints: correct the gap and review sooner, normally the next day.
- Unable to recall: re-teach with a different example, retry a small question, then review the next day.
- Missed a day: resume with the most useful due items; do not cram every overdue card before learning anything new.

After each attempt, log the specific error. “Weak at polity” is too broad. “Confused the elected government with the continuing state” gives the next mentor an actionable teaching task.

Four-week progress review

Use actual evidence: sessions attempted, explain-back answers, domain-specific question results, errors corrected and recalls maintained. Do not calculate an “IQ” or treat a single baseline score as a prediction of selection.

Keep the plan if it is manageable and comprehension is improving. Reduce new content and strengthen prerequisites if it is not. Increase workload only after two stable weeks and only if the learner wants and can sustain it. Do not erase missed sessions, fabricate completed lessons or award mastery from time spent.

Before selecting an exam attempt, confirm eligibility, the actual calendar, syllabus coverage, optional progress and practice evidence. Clearing UPSC is competitive and cannot be guaranteed; the next useful lesson can still be made clear and doable today.